

Material Prepared by: Team TNSED-Thanjavur

8th Standard English Study Material

Unit - 01 to 03

TNTET

SESSION-12

ENGLISH

Unit 1: The Nose Jewel - C. Rajagopalachari

Story Summary

- Two sparrows built a nest on the roof of Ramayya's house. The male bird told the female, "Let us mind our own business, see the cat does not come near our nest."
- Ramayya and his wife were simple people, not rich.
- The male bird picked up a diamond nose jewel in the muck heap and dropped it in Ramayya's house.
- His wife noticed it, took it, and wore it. Ramayya questioned her angrily, stating, "We must hand it over to the village magistrate."
- Meenakshi Ammal and her daughter searched for their missing jewel. Kuppayi, the maid-servant, was suspected of stealing it.
- The police searched Kuppayi's house. Ramayya's heart fluttered in fear, and his wife developed a severe fever and was confined to bed.
- The female bird remarked to the male, "It is all your doing. Did I tell her to steal the thing?"
- Ramayya and his wife lived in constant fear of being caught.
- **Moral:** We should never be greedy for what belongs to others.

About the Author

Chakravarti Rajagopalachari (1878-1972), informally called Rajaji, was an Indian politician, independence activist, lawyer, writer, historian, and statesman. He was born in the village of Thorapalli in the Krishnagiri district.

Rajagopalachari was the last Governor-General of India, as India soon became a Republic in 1950. Furthermore, he was the first Indian-born governor-general, since before him the posts were held by British nationals. He also served as leader of the Indian National Congress, Premier of the Madras Presidency, Governor of West Bengal, Minister for Home Affairs of the Indian Union, and Chief Minister of Madras state.

He was one of the first recipients of India's highest civilian award, the Bharat Ratna.

The first Bharat Ratna awards were presented in 1954 to three eminent individuals: C. Rajagopalachari (statesman), Dr. Sarvepalli Radhakrishnan (philosopher/second President), and C.V. Raman (physicist). Instituted on January 2, 1954, it is India's highest civilian honor, recognizing exceptional service in art, literature, science, and public service.

Glossary

Word	Meaning
self-centred (adj)	concerned with the self
disdain (n)	feeling of contempt or scorn
muck heap (n)	a pile of dung, soil or refuse
grub (n)	food
magistrate (n)	a judicial officer with limited authority to administer and enforce the law
disgrace (n)	the state of being dishonoured, or covered with shame
ignorant (adj)	unaware
consoled (v)	comforted (someone) in the time of grief or disappointment
suspected (v)	believed to be a cause or at fault
flutter (v)	to flap or wave quickly but irregularly
confined (v)	restricted, kept in a limited space or area
panic (adj)	frightened
cruel (adj)	merciless or heartless
gravely (adv)	in a grave or serious manner

Did You Know? A bird's eye takes up about 50 percent of its head; our eyes take up about 5 percent of our head. To be comparable to a bird's eyes, our eyes would have to be the size of baseballs.

Grammar & Vocabulary

Homophones

Homophones are words with the same pronunciation but different meanings, origins, or spellings.

Examples: new / knew, hole / whole, knight / night, see / sea.

a. Pick out the correct homophone:

1. I am not _____ to drink soda. (aloud, **allowed**)
2. The wind _____ the leaves. (blue, **blew**)
3. I will _____ my friend. (meat, **meet**)
4. He will play the _____ in the second play. (**role**, roll)
5. I have _____ the movie already. (scene, **seen**)

b. Choose the correct homophone:

1. Every morning my father likes to look at the _____ on the grass. (a) due **b) dew**
2. Chennai is the _____ of Tamilnadu. (a) capitol **b) capital**
3. I was very _____ last weekend because my friends went to the village without informing me. (**a) bored** b) board)
4. The cat caught the _____ of a mouse. (**a) scent** b) cent)
5. The _____ rises in the east. (a) son **b) sun**)

Abbreviations and Acronyms

Abbreviation: A shortened form of a word or phrase. (Example: PM - Prime Minister)

Abbreviation	Expansion
ATM	Automated Teller Machine
GB	Giga Byte
PC	Personal Computer
CEO	Chief Educational Officer

EMIS	Education Management Information System
IAS	Indian Administrative Service
NMMS	National Means cum Merit Scholarship
SBI	State Bank of India
OTP	One Time Password
IFSC	Indian Financial System Code
PDF	Portable Document Format
LED	Light Emitting Diode
UPS	Uninterruptible Power Supply
GST	Goods and Services Tax

Acronyms: A shortened form of a phrase usually made up of the initial letters of that phrase.
(Example: NATO - North Atlantic Treaty Organization)

Acronym	Expansion
AVADI	Armoured Vehicles and Ammunition Depot of India
RAM	Random Access Memory
ROM	Read-Only Memory
NEET	National Eligibility cum Entrance Test
UDISE	Unified District Information System for Education
PAN	Permanent Account Number
WHO	World Health Organization
NEWS	North, East, West and South
SIM	Subscriber Identification Module
LAN	Local Area Network
VAT	Value Added Tax

Expand the following (Self-Practice):

ECG, ILO, SCERT, IIT, ISRO, FIR, UNESCO, UNICEF, NASA, AIDS, ADHD, UFO, FAQ.

Greetings - 2 Types

Formal	Informal
Good morning / afternoon / evening!	Hi!
How are you?	Hey, how's it going?
It's good to see you.	What's up?

Letter Writing Formats

Formal Letter: Used in professional situations. Must be accurate and organized.

- Sender's address
- Date
- Name/designation and address of the receiver
- Subject
- Salutation
- Body of the letter
- Closing Paragraph
- Complimentary close
- Subscription (Sender's name/signature)

Informal Letter:

- Sender's address
- Date
- Salutation
- Body of the letter
- Closing Paragraph
- Complimentary close
- Subscription (Sender's Name)

Poem: Special Hero

By: Christina M Kerschen

*When I was a baby,
you would hold me in your arms.
I felt the love and tenderness,
keeping me safe from harm.*

*I would look up into your eyes,
and all the love I would see.
How did I get so lucky,
you were the dad chosen for me.*

*There is something special
about a father's love.
Seems it was sent to me
from someplace up above.*

*Our love is everlasting,
I just wanted you to know.
That you're my special hero
and I wanted to tell you so.*

Parallel Reading: "Only a Dad" by Edgar Albert Guest (British born American poet, also known as the people's poet).

The Woman in Platform 8 - Ruskin Bond

Story Notes

- A semi-autobiographical short story.
- **Symbolism:** White sari = pure, innocent, goodness.
- Arun, a 12-year-old boy in his second year at boarding school (and best bowler), is at Platform 8, Ambala Station.
- He is waiting for the midnight northern-bound train, pacing the platform, browsing the bookstall, and feeding stray dogs amidst a tide of people.
- A woman in a white sari asks, "Are you all alone, my son?" She has a pale face, kind eyes, no jewels, and seems poor but dignified, commanding respect.
- She orders tea, samosas, and jalebis for Arun and talks about his school, friends, likes, and dislikes, but never asks about his family or address.
- When a boy leaps off the platform, a spasm of pain and fear shows on her face.

- Arun's schoolmate Satish and his mother turn up. The kind woman introduces herself as Arun's mother. Arun dislikes Satish's mother, who gives advice not to talk to strangers.
- When the train arrives, Satish's mother hands a bag of fruits, a cricket bat, and a box of chocolates. Arun kisses the kind woman and says, "Good bye mother."

About the Author

Ruskin Bond is a short story writer, novelist, and poet, widely considered the favourite writer of Indian children. His first novel, *Room on the Roof*, was published when he was still in his teens and won him the John Rhys Memorial Award in 1957.

He writes about children and the simple hill folk of Uttarakhand. Simplicity, fluency of language, and an insight into human nature are hallmarks of his style. Major writings include *An Island of Trees*, *A Bond with the Mountains*, and *The India I Love*. He was honoured with the Sahitya Akademi Award for his contribution to Indian literature.

Unit 2: Hobby Turned into Successful Career

Section 1: Mani

- Mani is a school boy whose hobby is writing. Initially, he found it difficult to read and write.
- His grandfather noticed and helped by reading him bedtime stories.
- Hobbies are unique to people. They are activities done in our spare time. (e.g., Collecting stamps - philately, a collector is a philatelist).
- For Mani, writing is like "painting our voice-world with magic and magicians." He wants to become a writer like R.K. Narayan.
- **Quotes:** "Whatever you like to do, make it a hobby" - Warren Buffet. "Writing is easy, all you have to do is cross out the wrong words" - Mark Twain.
- Former Chief Minister of Tamil Nadu, Mr. C.N. Annadurai, was a writer of books, stories, plays, articles, and cinema dialogues.

Glossary (Section 1)

Word	Meaning
unique (adj)	distinctive / uncommon

exhaust (v)	tire out
energises (v)	give energy
passionate (adj)	intense / heartfelt
accurately (adv)	exactly
fiction (n)	imaginative writing
spare (adj)	extra

Section 2: Ajay Kumar Garg

- Ajay Kumar Garg is a talented artist living in Jaipur, India.
- He suffered an injury at the age of three, and the treatment left him permanently hearing impaired.
- His father bought him a paint set to play with. When Ajay was 5, court artist of Dholpur Rajasthan, Shri Sua Lal, started training him.
- He tried tailoring but wasn't happy, eventually becoming an apprentice to Asha Devi, who taught him "traditional Indian miniature painting."
- He mastered the technique of preparing colors and brushes, using a magnifying glass and a single-haired brush for miniature paintings (like a grain of rice, smaller than 3 inches).
- He showcased his work throughout INDIA, USA, UK.
- In 2004, he was awarded a national award of accomplishment from Dr. APJ Abdul Kalam. He is an executive member of the Deaf & Dumb Association in Rajasthan.

Section 3: Ilavazhagi

- Mr. Irudayaraj, a fish-cart driver and Ilavazhagi's father, was a district-level champion in carrom. He began coaching her when she was around 5.
- She is a member of the Thiruvallur District Carrom Association and represents India at the carrom world championship and Asian championship.
- **Achievements:**
 - World cup winner in 2006.
 - 5th world champion, 2008 in France.
 - Women's singles title in 37th senior national carrom championship Chennai, 2008.
 - 13th SAARC carrom championship women's doubles with Rashmi Kumara in 2009.
 - 2 times SAARC carrom champion women's singles title in 2009.

- 2010 championship in US - secured 1st place in singles & doubles.
- 260 medals (106 gold, 17 silver, 12 bronze) in nationals.
- 111 gold, 9 silver, 5 bronze in international SAARC events.

SAARC Details: Includes Bangladesh, Bhutan, India, Maldives, Nepal, Pakistan, Sri Lanka (1985). Afghanistan joined in 2007. India hosted SAARC 3 times: 1986 (Bangalore, 2nd), 1995 (Delhi, 8th), and 2007 (Delhi, 14th).

Vocabulary: Singular and Plural

Some nouns become plural in different ways:

Rule	Singular	Plural
Changing the vowels	man	men
	foot	feet
	tooth	teeth
	goose	geese
'is' changes into 'es'	hypothesis	hypotheses
	oasis	oases
	crisis	crises
'us' changes into 'i'	cactus	cacti
	fungus	fungi
	syllabus	syllabi
'um' changes into 'a'	bacterium	bacteria
	medium	media
	curriculum	curricula
Same form for singular and plural	deer	deer
	fish	fish

	hair	hair
	furniture	furniture
	luggage	luggage
Add 's' to first word in Hyphenated word	passer-by	passers-by
	sister-in-law	sisters-in-law
	brother-in-law	brothers-in-law
	runner-up	runners-up

Write the plural form (Self-Practice):

1. food, 2. radius, 3. governor-general, 4. syllabus, 5. datum, 6. commander-in-chief, 7. thesis, 8. forum, 9. cattle, 10. genius.

Compound Words

Compound words are formed when two or more words are put together to form a new word with a new meaning.

Type	Word 1	Word 2	Compound Word
NOUN + NOUN	head	master	head master
	key	board	keyboard
	cell	phone	cell phone
	school	boy	school boy
	eye	sight	eyesight
	home	work	homework
	moon	light	moon light
	note	book	notebook
GERUND + NOUN	dining	hall	Dinning hall

	washing	machine	Washing machine
	waiting	hall	Waiting hall
	driving	school	driving school
	walking	stick	Walking stick
	drawing	room	Drawing room
	calling	bell	calling bell
	baking	soda	baking soda
NOUN + VERB	snow	fall	snowfall
	car	park	Car park
	book	mark	bookmark
	sun	set	sun set
	cat	walk	catwalk
	rain	fall	Rainfall
	hair	cut	Haircut
	tooth	ache	Toothache

A. Match the words:

match+box, air+port, blood+bank, Pop+corn, sky+blue, hair+cut, book+mark, sewing+machine.

B. Choose the best answer to make a compound word:

1. Placed after 'soft'? (a) play **b) ware** c) run d) cycle)
2. Placed before 'light'? (a) try **b) sun** c) horse d) cat)
3. Placed after 'safe'? (a) chair **b) guard** c) shop d) van)
4. Placed after 'blue'? (a) cane **b) print** c) see d) land)
5. Placed after 'water'? (a) food b) stick **c) fall** d) out)

Poem: My Hobby: Reading

By: Arunachalam Chandrasekharan

*My hobby is reading
It helps me
In thought breeding.*

*It takes me to places
Near and far,
It keeps my rational
Doors ajar.*

*It teaches me
To cackle and cry
Without wings
It lets me fly.*

*I wish
If all the children could read,
In constructing a vigorous society,
Then we shall succeed.*

Figures of Speech: Rhyming words, Rhyme scheme.

Parallel Reading: "Good books" by Edgar Guest.

A Hunter Turned Naturalist - Jim Corbett

- Edward James Corbett popularly known as Jim Corbett was a British wild life photographer, hunter, tracker, naturalist and writer.
- He hunted man-eating tigers and leopards in India. People can't run as fast as animals.
- He liked to shoot with his cine film camera and had a dog named Robin. He did not like to kill wild animals for pleasure and sport.
- **The Champawat Tiger:** A Bengal tigress man-eater. A tiger starts eating humans when they grow old or get hurt.
 - Responsible for nearly 436 deaths in Nepal and Kumaon areas of India. Listed in the Guinness Book of World Records for highest number of fatalities from a tiger.
 - The tigress began attacks in Rupal village in western Nepal, Himalayas. The Nepalese Army drove her across the border into India, continuing her killings in the Kumaon District (all in daylight).

- Corbett managed to kill the tigress in 1907 when it killed a 16-year-old girl in Champawat and left a trail of blood. Corbett organised a bait near the Champa river with 300 villagers. The tiger was shot dead near the Chataar bridge.
- A cement board was erected. Post-mortem showed her upper and lower canine teeth on the right side were broken (result of an old gunshot from a game hunter).
- Deforestation and human encroachment are main causes of the mischief of wild animals.
- Corbett gave lecturing tours about natural heritage and conservation. He promoted the "Association for prevention of game" and "All India conference for the preservation of wildlife".
- Played a key role in establishing India's first national park (Asia's 1st national park) in the Kumaon hills in the 1930s. Initially named "The Hailey National Park" (after Lord Malcolm Hailey).
- Jim Corbett died on April 19, 1955. The park was renamed as "The Jim Corbett National Park" in 1957.

Jadav Payeng - The Forest Man of India

Jadav "Molai" Payeng (born Oct 31, 1959), an environmental activist and forestry worker from the indigenous Mising tribe in Majuli, Assam. Over 30 years, he planted and tended trees on a sandbar of the river Brahmaputra, creating a real man-made forest of 1,360 acres (550 ha) called Molai forest. In 2015, he was awarded the Padma Shri, India's 4th highest civilian award.

Unit 3: Sir Issac Newton - The Ingenious Scientist

Story Notes (by Nathaniel Hawthorne)

- To entertain his children (Edward, George, Emily), Mr. Temple tells stories about the childhood of famous people.
- Isaac Newton was born on Christmas day (Dec 25), 1642, in the small village of Woolsthorpe in England.
- When Mrs. Newton remarried a clergyman and moved, Isaac was left to the care of his grandmother.
- He was chiefly remarkable for his ingenuity. "He will make a capital workman," people said. He became an apprentice to a clockmaker.

- Besides his mechanical skill, he had a taste for mathematics. He created unique water clocks and sundials.
- To find out the strength of the wind, he jumped against the wind. He constructed a working model of a windmill.
- He attended the University of Cambridge and was the first to find out the nature of light and the force of gravity.
- He explained the mechanism of the universe, was made a member of parliament, and received knighthood from the king.
- On March 31, 1727, 85-year-old Sir Isaac Newton died. He observed: *"I seem to myself like a child playing on the sea-shore, picking up here and there a curious shell or a pretty pebble, where the boundless ocean of truth lies undiscovered before me."*
- (Side note: Wheels are our greatest invention. David Rittenhouse, an American, made a little water mill when he was seven or eight.)

About the Author

Nathaniel Hawthorne (July 4, 1804 - May 19, 1864) was an American novelist, dark romantic, and short story writer. His works focus on history, morality, and religion. He was born in Salem, Massachusetts. The story is from his book *The Stories from History and Biography* (1851).

Grammar: Prefix and Suffix

Prefix: An affix placed before the root word, changing it into a new word (e.g., un + happy = unhappy).

Prefix	Meaning	Examples
Re-	Again	rewrite, remix, relocate
Un-	Not	unexpected, unkind, untrue, unhook, unlucky, unlock, unsafe
Pre-	Before	prereading
Dis-	not	disrespect, dislike, distrust, disown, disclose
Im-	not	impossible
Non-	not	nonsense

Mis-	wrong	misbehave
Bi-	two	bicycle

Suffix: An affix placed after the root word. Changes meaning and grammatical function.

Root word	Suffix	New Word
happy	-ness	happiness
colour	-ful	colourful, beautiful
friend	-ship	friendship
fat / drive	-er / -ing	fatter, driving, lying
change / use	-able / -less	changeable, useless

Grammar: Syllabification

Syllabification is the process of dividing words into syllables or units of vowel sounds. There are 6 types:

Type	Examples
Monosyllabic (1)	act, cat, book, head, see, all, tongue, plot, steel, wish, one, school, break, rhythm, make, life, ball, bat
Disyllabic / Bisyllabic (2)	a-gain, rub-ber, be-side, in-stead, de-lay, wo-men, pur-pose, pro-gramme, van-quish, out-break, mo-ral, di-rect, co-ward, en-ding, care-ful, sus-pect, lead-er, re-joice
Trisyllabic (3)	beau-ti-ful, to-mor-row, po-pu-lar, in-ten-tion, per-mi-ssion, ef-fec-tive, lu-per-cal, mu-ti-ny, le-ga-cy, be-lov-ed, de-part-ment, for-tu-nate, be-ne-fit, as-sem-bly, con-si-der, e-le-ment, tra-di-tion, im-pli-cit
Tetrasyllabic (4)	u-su-al-ly, mi-li-ta-ry, in-tel-li-gent, e-co-no-my, in-he-ri-ted, se-cu-ri-ty, lo-ca-li-ty, e-qua-li-ty, pub-li-ci-ty, mo-ra-li-ty, im-me-di-ate, ki-lo-me-ter, oc-cu-pa-tion, gen-er-a-tion, tech-no-lo-gy, mul-ti-me-dia, u-ni-ver-sity, par-ti-cu-lar
Pentasyllabic (5)	ex-a-mi-na-tion, com-mu-ni-ca-tion, i-ma-gi-na-tion, qua-li-fi-ca-tion, re-pre-sen-ta-tion, spe-ci-fi-ca-tion, par-ti-ci-pa-tion, in-ter-pre-ta-tion, e-va-

	lu-a-tion, de-ter-mi-na-tion, ac-com-mo-da-tion, re-pre-sen-ta-tive, mo-di-fi-ca-tion, per-so-na-li-ty, jus-ti-fi-ca-tion, in-i-ti-a-tive, fun-da-men-tally, ne-go-ti-a-tion
Polysyllabic (6+)	au-tho-ri-ta-ri-an, in-fe-ri-o-ri-ty, per-son-i-fi-ca-tion, con-sti-tu-tion-al-ly, dis-qu-a-li-fi-ca-tion, syl-lab-i-fi-ca-tion, en-cy-clo-pe-di-a, au-to-bi-o-gra-phy, hu-ma-ni-ta-ri-an, au-di-o-vi-su-al, in-com-pre-hen-si-ble, he-ter-o-ge-ne-ous, i-den-ti-fi-ca-tion, phy-si-o-the-ra-pist, un-de-li-ve-ra-ble, in-ter-ro-ga-to-ry, sub-sti-tu-tion-a-ry, mis-pro-nun-ci-a-tion

Syllabify the following words (Self-Practice):

1. education, 2. School, 3. college, 4. english, 5. Opportunity, 6. friend, 7. teacher, 8. simultaneously, 9. laboratory, 10. Beneficiary.

Poem: Making Life Worth While

By: George Eliot

*Every soul that touches yours -
Be it the slightest contact - Get
there from some good;
Some little grace; one kindly thought;
One aspiration yet unfelt;
One bit of courage
For the darkening sky;
One gleam of faith
To brave the thickening ills of life;
One glimpse of brighter skies -
To make this life worth while And
heaven a surer heritage.*

About the Poet

Mary Ann Evans (1819-1880), known by her pen name (pseudonym) **George Eliot**, was an English novelist, poet, journalist, translator, and one of the leading writers of the Victorian era. She wrote seven novels.

Figure of speech - Repetition: A literary device that repeats the same words or phrases a few times to make an idea clearer and more memorable. Used to emphasize a feeling, create rhythm, and bring attention to an idea.

The Three Questions - Leo Tolstoy

Story Notes

- The story is about a king who is in search of answers to three philosophical questions:
 1. When is the right time to begin something?
 2. Which people should he listen to?
 3. What is the most important thing for him to do?
- He decides to meet a wise hermit living in the woods. When the king reaches the hut, the hermit is digging the ground. The king asks his questions, but the hermit continues to dig.
- The king helps him dig. Hours pass, and it gets dark.
- A bearded man comes running towards them with a bleeding wound in his stomach. The king dresses his wounds, carries him to bed, and sleeps on the floor out of exhaustion.
- The next morning, the bearded man asks for forgiveness. He reveals he was the king's enemy seeking revenge, but the king's bodyguard stabbed him. Since the king saved his life, the man pledges to be his servant. The king forgives him and promises to return his seized property.
- The king begs the hermit for answers again. The hermit explains the answers are already there through his actions:
 - If the king had not helped dig, he would have left early and been stabbed. *Helping was the most important time; the hermit was the most important person; doing the hermit good was the most important thing.*
 - Later, caring for the wounded man was the most important time; the man in pain was the most important person; dressing his wounds was the most important thing.
- **Conclusion:**
 - The most important time is **NOW** (we only have power to act in the present).
 - The most important person is **the person you are with** at a particular time.
 - The most important business is **to do good deeds** (we were sent to this world for that purpose).

About the Author

Leo Tolstoy (1828 - 1910) was a Russian writer who is regarded as one of the greatest authors of all time. He is best known for the novels *War and Peace* (1869) and *Anna Karenina* (1877).